



Process Centric IT Service Offering

AGILE ALIGNMENT OF BPM AND SOA

After seeing a multitude of SOA projects and technologies, it becomes apparent that BPM and SOA development tools do not promote effective design or governance on their own. An army of developers without proper direction can script thousands of jumbled services that meet requirements, but fail to create an important layer of abstraction where business processes can reign and mature.

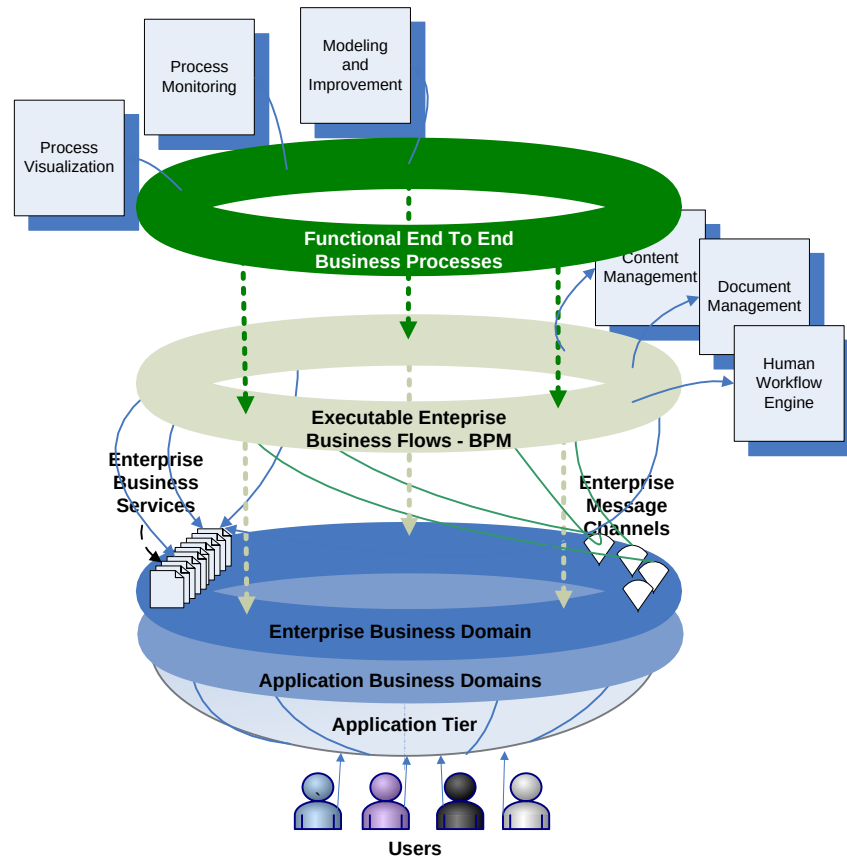
SOA/BPM Architects have found an important layer of abstraction between the SOA tier and the BPM Tier that provide application independence, promote loose coupling, and separate decision logic from underlying business services. This layer can appropriately be called the Enterprise Business Domain, where Business Objects, Messages, and Services can be standardized for use by every business process and service component that plays within the enterprise domain. An Application Integration Architecture can then be used in the SOA tier to connect all Application Domains to the strongly defined Enterprise Domain

A strongly defined Enterprise Business Domain is critical toward achieving an agile, extendable, and customizable business process management solution. Once the SOA has been contained, additional process hierarchies and architectures are necessary to carry agility into the executable and functional process tiers.

ALIGNED BPM AND SOA

A process centric paradigm has proven an effective way to organize IT, but given the governance challenges of SOA alone, adding an additional BPM Tier will not spontaneously organize the chaos. A BPM Layer changes the priorities of the SOA, by creating a definitive place for process logic and business monitoring that can be guided by process models.

APPLICATION INTEGRATION ARCHITECTURE



One of the difficult things to grasp with SOA, is the sheer power that can be placed in each SOA Component without a meaningful design. AIA helps clearly define the role of each tier to help with organizing the SOA, but also directs how the myriad of technologies should be used and associated.

Under the covers of each tier, is the same technology standards such as service orchestration (BPEL), routing services, transformations (XSLT/XQUERY), mediators, extension services, service bus) arranged as an assembly line of Service Components.

Tame your SOA with Application Integration Architecture (AIA):

Prioritize and Model your Processes

- Well organized functional process models will inform your IT where the business needs differentiation, visibility, and agility.
- Allow you analysts to think about what a best practice is for your organization without being weighed down by unwanted details

Define your Enterprise Business Domain

- Identify the Business Services that your numerous business processes will require
- Create a canonical data model to standardize the representation of Business Objects and Messages

Expose your Application Domains

- Inbound and Outbound adapters to expose events and externally drive functionality

Create your AIA

- Connect your Enterprise Domain to your Application Domains with Business Connectors

Executable Processes

- Create a process hierarchy with standardized monitoring
- Integrate with Applications, Document Management, and Human Workflow

Business Users and Leadership

- Create collaborative user interfaces to disseminate relevant info and actions to each business user
- Provide Business Intelligence, Activity Monitoring, and Process Visualization to Leaders to inspire Continuous Business Transformation

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DRIVING AGILITY THROUGH AIA

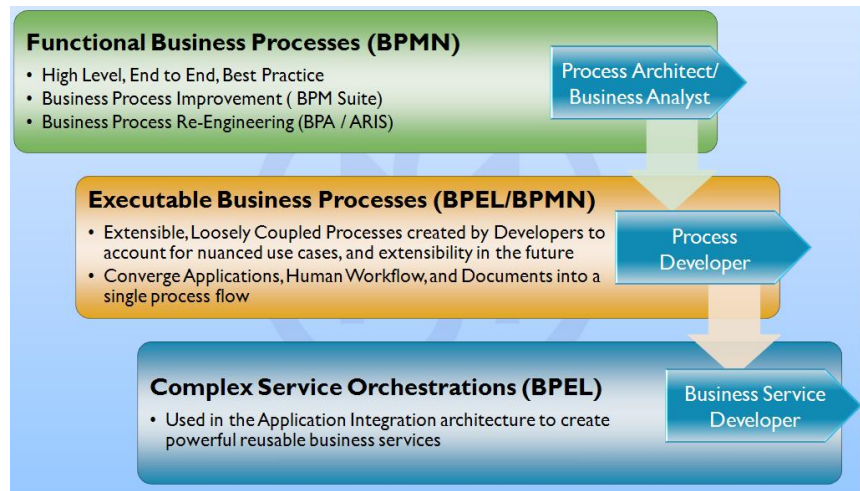
Application Integration Architecture (AIA) has been branded by Oracle as the cure all for integrating hundreds of apps with a hundred other apps that can be plugged into different clients, and easily extended in an out of box fashion.

Oracle's different industry verticle AIA packages may be just the cure to instantly achieving a robust architecure, but is more than likely overkill for an organizations enterprise tier. After all, AIA is merely a conglomeration of best practice SOA design principles and implementation standards, so your organization may benefit by tailoring the design on top of the existing Service Infrastructure.

ORGANIZING PROCESSES

The most important aspect introduced by AIA is the encouragement of the SOA environment to facilitate different business process layers and promote a new paradigm of Business Intelligence.

The diagram on the right illustrates some of the process tiers that exist within the SOA and give IT a direct line to the business.



LAUNCHING YOUR OWN APPLICATION INTEGRATION ARCHITECTURE

In general the new technologies such as BPM and SOA have made programming a lot more clear and effective. The biggest risks to projects still will occur in Application Adapters where implementation timelines can vary drastically. M&S Consulting can help your organization negotiate BPM and SOA Technologies and build out a simple and effective plan for adopting a solution that works in your organization.



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